'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Winter 2021

You've Got Mail!

by Dawne Holz, Treasurer



Checking your inbox is now more important than ever! Hopefully, all owners are now receiving CMA invoices by email!

In December, CMA implemented emailed invoices and online payments for Water/Sewer bills. Many customers took advantage of the convenient link in the email to pay online. Using that unique link, payments can be made with a debit card, credit card, or an echeck (ACH). Of course, owners still have the option to mail a check to CMA or initiate payment from their own bank's online payment system. Emailing invoices saves CMA the costs of printing, stuffing, and mailing invoices to our owners (about $300/year - just in postage).

The Board also approved this process for the 2021 Annual Assessment billing and all future bills. The assessment invoices were emailed to all owners in early January. CMA will no longer mail invoices or statements. Please be sure we have a valid email address. Check the Member Directory on the CMA website - it lists what we currently have in our records. If you haven't already, consider providing a second email address. This could be a co-owner of the property or a secondary email address you use - like home or work.

CMA will no longer mail invoices or statements. Please be sure we have a valid email address!

If you didn't receive your 2021 Annual Assessment invoice via email, you should have gotten one by USPS mail. We mailed printed invoices - one last time - to owners who had not yet paid their assessment by mid-January. The mailing included information about how to update your email address(es). For detais on how to troubleshoot non-receipt of these emails, please read the post titled "CMA Online Payments - Important Please Read" in the CMA Google Group.

As always, if you have questions about your Assessment and/or Water/Sewer account, please contact Brenda Close, CMA Bookkeeper, at 304-258-4742 or brendac@closecpa.com.

UPCOMING EVENTS

CMA Committee Meetings	February 2021	Date/Time set by Committee
Board of Directors Meeting	March 13, 10:00 am	Teleconference
CMA Committee Meetings	April 2021	Date/Time set by Committee

HAPPY ANNIVERSARY

Back in February 1981...

by Mark Johnson, K-2

... Lisa and I arrived at the Country Inn to celebrate our honeymoon. Yep, it will be 40 YEARS that we have been married in February 2021. Yikes! I mean hooray! As Lisa is fond of saying, "It's been seven of the best years of my life."

Since that momentous month in 1981, Lisa and I would occasionally return to Berkeley Springs to celebrate our anniversary. In February 2016, we rented a house in CMA to celebrate. Upon returning to our permanent residence in Maryland, we thought we would just look and see what was for sale in CMA. After a few months of looking, we eventually bought K-2 in August of 2016.

We're very happy to be part of the CMA family. We will keep the celebration to a low roar in accordance with CMA guidelines.

Cheers!



Winter view from their deck, Dennis Brydges (Q-4)

Assessments Paid?

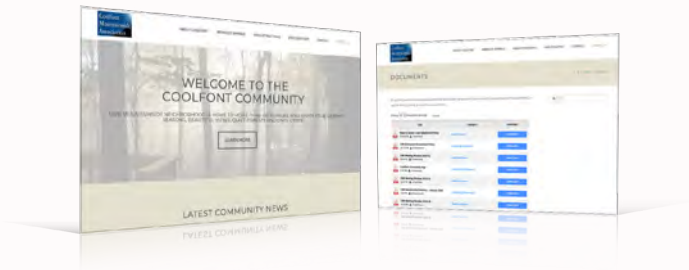
Assessment invoices were emailed to owners on December 31, 2020. Payments are due January 1, 2021 and a late fee will be assessed after January 31, 2021.

Please note that late fees have increased to 10% of the outstanding balance. Monthly finance charges also apply to accounts that are past due.

Owners now have the option to pay assessments with a credit card, debit card, or echeck (ACH). Use the link in the billing email.

Please note the assessment amounts for 2021:

Assessment for Houses	$1,570
Assessment for Lots	$900
Pool Fee, Rental Property (due May)	$73



CMA Website

The CMA website is a great resource for information for owners/residents. In the "Owners" section, you'll find information about contracted services (Site Manager, snow plowing, and Water/Sewer). There's also a Community Calendar, contact information for Committee members, Firewise resources, and general FAQs about the community.

In the Documents section, you can read through all the years of newsletters, check out Board Meeting minutes, and/or review the governing documents. There are also forms for the DACC and Firewise.

Finally, we've included a list of contractors your CMA neighbors have used and recommend. You'll find all this, and more, at:

www.coolfontmountainside.com.

Click on Owners and enter the username: **owner** and password: **coolfont**.

Fireplace Safety Tips

American Academy of Pediatrics (© 2017)

from Heidi Splane, Firewise Chair

- If possible, keep a window cracked open while the fire is burning.
- Be certain the damper or flue is open before starting a fire. Keeping the damper or flue open until the fire is out will draw smoke out of the house. The damper can be checked by looking up into the chimney with a flashlight or mirror. Do not close the damper until the embers have completely stopped burning.
- Use dry and well-aged wood. Wet or green wood causes more smoke and contributes to soot buildup in the chimney. Dried wood burns with less smoke and burns more evenly,
- Smaller pieces of wood placed on a grate burn faster and produce less smoke.
- Clean out ashes from previous fires. Levels of ash at the base of the fireplace should be kept to 1 inch or less because a thicker layer restricts the air supply to logs, resulting in more smoke.
- The chimney should be checked annually by a professional.
- Even if the chimney is not due for cleaning, it is important to check for animal nests or other blockages that could prevent smoke from escaping.
- Minimize your child's chance of burns from the hot glass front of some fireplaces, including gas fireplaces. Safety screens can be installed to reduce the risk of burns.
- Make sure the area around the fireplace is clear of anything that is potentially flammable (ie: furniture, drapes, newspapers, books, etc.). If these items get too close to the fireplace, they could catch fire.
- Never leave a fire in the fireplace unattended. Make sure it is completely out before going to bed or leaving the house.

Directory Updates



Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We will also update the PDF available on the CMA website.

R-4 Steve Himmelrich
stevehimmelrich@gmail.com (410) 336-3141
Eileen Fader
ebf0422@gmail.com (410) 608-8020
Part Time Residents

R-7 Ronald Leapline
ronleapline@yahoo.com (681) 283-0658
Jennifer Leapline
mullins301@yahoo.com (304) 620-3760
Full Time Residents

Check it out!
"Dan Doofus" in "Hot Flashes"
A cute fire safety video.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5BqR4WNd3lA&feature=youtu.be





- If you leave the room while the fire is burning or the fireplace is still hot, take your small child with you.
- Put fireplace tools and accessories out of a young child's reach. Also, remove any lighters and matches.
- Install both smoke and carbon monoxide detectors. Test them monthly and change the batteries at least once a year.
- Keep a fire extinguisher on hand.
- Talk with children as early as possible the dangers of fires and the heat coming from them.

Put a FREEZE on Winter Fires

Home fires occur more in winter than in any other season. As you stay cozy and warm this winter, be fire smart!

DEC JAN FEB

Half of all home heating fires occur in December, January and February.

1 in every 7 home fires and **1 in every 5** home fire deaths involves heating equipment.

3 feet

Keep anything that can burn **at least 3 feet** from any heat source like fireplaces, wood stoves, radiators or space heaters.

Keep portable generators **outside, away from windows, and as far away** from your home as possible.

Install and test carbon monoxide alarms **at least once a month.**

Plug only **1 heat-producing appliance** (like a space heater) into an electrical outlet at a time.

Have a qualified professional clean and inspect your chimney and vents **every year.**

Store cooled ashes in a tightly covered metal container, and keep it **outside at least 10 feet** from your home and any nearby buildings.

FEMA | U.S. Fire Administration | Fire is Everyone's Fight | NFPA

For more information on how to prevent winter fires, visit **www.usfa.fema.gov/winter** and **www.nfpa.org/winter.**



December snow at sunrise, Eileen Neely (E-9)



December snow, Kelsey Lindblad (P-7)

Reminder: Outdoor Lights

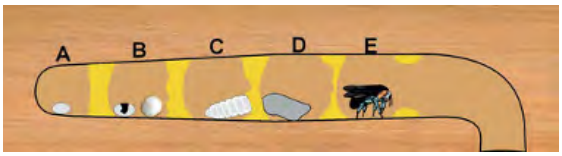
Our Neighborhood Watch volunteers ask that owners ensure that outside security lights are turned off by 11pm each night or operate on a motion detector. If you are leaving lights on in anticipation of guests arriving, it might be time to investigate installation of a motion detector for outdoor lighting. It will also save on electricity bills. We still have several houses that leave outdoor lights on all day and night. Nearby neighbors, who suffer the consequences of lights left on at night, will much appreciate owners' efforts to reduce usage and save energy.

Buzz Kill: Carpenter Bees

by Tom Holz (F-1)

If you live at CMA and have wood siding, decking, fascia, or logs, you've probably seen carpenter bees or their results: ½" holes or "saw dust" in unexpected places. They can turn your wood into swiss cheese over time! Plus woodpeckers love to tear up the wood to get a tasty meal of carpenter bee larvae!

Though they look menacing, for the most part Carpenter Bees are harmless. Unlike honeybees, bumble bees, and wasps, only the females have stingers and usually sting only when VERY perturbed. Their ½" holes conceal a secret...they're actually nests with eggs - creating the next generation! They chew in, creating the ½" hole and "saw dust," turn 90° and tunnel 6" to 3' sideways!



Momma bees lay an egg, seal it off, lay an egg, etc., working toward the hole you see. The young will come back, often to the same nest or area, lengthen/enlarge the original nest or chew their own nearby! After a few years, the wood that was your home is a holey mess!

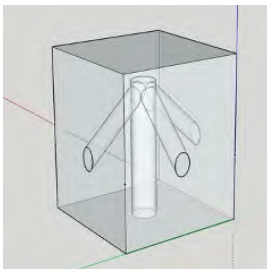
To repair existing "nests" and damage, you can hire someone or do it yourself, but be wary of working on a high ladder! Take a bendable wire or small coil spring, put it in the hole turning/twisting to make the 90° turn and "drill" through the sealed larvae chambers; otherwise baby bees will chew their way out. Next, use an insecticide, like Drione powder with a duster ball, or a spray or foam to treat the holes. Some people fill the hole part way with steel wool, others fill the hole with caulking to match the exterior, or you can glue in a ½" dowel (an almost perfect fit!) before staining or painting.

To inhibit further problems, buy or make carpenter bee traps and place in the area where you've treated nests. You can buy various styles for about $15-20 each. Or, make your own! Use scrap 4x4 or two 2x4's glued together with a plastic 20 oz frosty beverage you've enjoyed (keep the screw top!).

It's a Trap!



Cut a 5" length of 4x4, measure up from the bottom middle of each side 2" and mark it. Drill a hole from the marks in and toward the top of the 4x4 at a 45° angle. Drill a 7/8" to 1" hole from the center of the bottom toward the top, intersecting the four side holes. Now, drill a ½" to 7/8" hole in a drink bottle screw top (easiest if left screwed on the bottle). Glue the bottle top - with thread facing out - into the large hole on the bottom of the 4x4 and let it set (don't glue the top to the bottle!). Screw the bottle into the bottle top. Mount the trap near the old bee nest, hanging it on a nail in one of the side holes, or put a small ¼" eyebolt in the top and either string it up or use a ¼"x 6-8" screw spike thru the eye bolt. Depending on how you hang them, the wind may bang them against the side of the house, so take care how you mount them.



Instead of a plastic drink bottle, you can use a small jar with a screw on lid. Drill the same ½" to 1" hole in the middle of the lid, plus one small hole to either side of the larger one. Mount the lid to the 4x4 with two small screws through the two small holes, lining up the larger holes in the lid and 4x4. Screw on the jar, and you're done.

Nesting bees will see the ½" hole in the trap, think it may be home (they're not real smart), and enter the trap. They see the light from the bottle/jar and think they're headed back "outside." Once in the bottle/jar, they try to fly, their wings hit the sides knocking them down, and rarely find their way out! It may take a day or two for the bees to find the trap, but once one does, others will follow. Reportedly, live bees are attracted by the smell of dead bees, so don't empty your trap too often. Just unscrew the bottle/jar, shake out the dead bees, and screw it back on.

Neighbors! Tom has several of his bee traps to donate to neighbors. Contact him at tlholz@me.com.

Japanese Barberry

from Wonderful West Virginia Magazine, January 2021 (Very edited for space)



Japanese barberry, *Berberis thunbergii*, prized for its hardy constitution and vibrant colors, has played the roles of both silent protector and ornamental backdrop since it was first introduced in the late 19th century.

Barberry is a beautiful plant. It grows in a lush rainbow of greens and reds and it's great at keeping pests like deer out, thanks to its dangerously spiny branches. Once well rooted, it gets comfortable in a wide range of soil and light conditions. Though it doesn't particularly enjoy very wet or very dry landscapes, it will grow without much fuss, bloom and set fruit.

That, coupled with its prolific nature of putting out clusters of bright berries from July to October, barberry always had the potential to get out of hand. It was only a matter of time. Unfortunately, starting in the northwest, it invaded untended areas of forest and farmland and crept across the country and into West Virginia. Barberry has since found its way into protected habitats, state parks, wetlands, and agricultural fields in the state.

Dirty Secrets

Where exactly did this deceptively beautiful plant go wrong? First, barberry creates a microclimate that is very good for deer ticks. It grows thick and wild and its multiple stems and dense clusters of alternate leaves trap cool, dark, humid spaces - a perfect environment for blood-sucking pests.

Japanese barberry also replaces native species, partly because it grows nearly anywhere, and partly because, with its prickly attitude, nothing wants to eat it. This Japanese transplant can even change the soil chemistry around itself to make it less hospitable to native plants of all kinds. And these changes can be irreversible. Cacapon State Park, for example, has a lot of barberry and the state spends a lot of money trying to eradicate it.

What to Do



Owners may opt to leave their plants and risk them spreading, they could try to keep them under control, or they could replace the shrubs with something new. If you are going to keep it, cut it back and trim it on a regular basis, so you don't get as many berries. Eradicating it altogether can prove to be a challenge if the plant is well-established. You can dig it out and replace barberry with other shrubs: compact, purple-leaved cultivars of weigela for color and for deer resistance or shrub roses, such as the Knock Out series, offer thorny dividers in the same vein as barberry. Winterberry and inkberry holly, are both prickly evergreens and very durable, adapting well to many soils and growing over six feet tall. Bayberries and chokeberries are also options. Finding a plant with beautiful foliage, a strong constitution, deer resistance, and the willingness to grow anywhere is a tall order.

Turning Over a New Leaf

Currently, no new barberry plants should be added to landscapes. After all, maintaining the health and vitality of the state's ecosystems and agriculture is crucial.



Forest understory overtaken by Japanese barberry

Rules & Regulations: Trash Control Policy

In November, the Board approved Resolution 2020-05 Trash Control Policy. Here are some excerpts from this Policy. **Residents are encouraged to review the entire text of the Policy**, available at www.coolfontmountainside.org in the Owners/Documents section.

I. Overview

A. Each owner is responsible for proper disposal of trash resulting from their properties use, whether by themselves, guests, or tenants. Further, owners are responsible for providing instruction to guests and tenants on proper trash disposal, including use of any trash bins and containers provided in a manner that protects themselves, wildlife, and the community.

B. Owners may stipulate self-haul away of trash to remote collection sites or may contract for collection with a local trash collection company.

C. Owners, guests, or tenants that contract for trash collection:

1. Must collect or maintain trash ... in a wildlife proof container.
2. Will only use exterior containers that are heavy duty, well-constructed, and "bearproof," and maintain them to remain so. Exterior containers must have lockable lids that strongly deter, if not prevent, wildlife access, as well as to prevent trash distribution ... weather.
3. Owners that have guests or tenants must prominently post on their premises the instructions for use of the exterior containers .... Further, owners will refrain from using and advise guests and tenants not to use other owner's exterior trash containers.
4. Overflowing exterior trash containers are not allowed. Any trash that does not fit in and allow proper closure and locking of container lids must be self-hauled to a local trash collector or be maintained interior to the residence until the exterior unit is emptied or the trash is self-hauled away.

II. Enforcement

A. Owners whose trash containers are broken into, no matter the means, are responsible for cleaning up the trash from their own property and wherever it has spread, as well as re-securing, repairing, or disposing of the trash container.

1. Members or visitors who observe trash containers breached by wildlife or overflowing will try to inform the owner [and] the CMA Site Manager, providing the lot owner's name and lot number, if known. The Site Manager, ... will make official notification to the owner of their responsibility to remedy the situation.
2. Owners have 48 hours from notification to remedy the situation.
3. After 48-hours ..., the owner will become liable for a trash clean-up fee at a rate of $25 per trash bag, as determined by CMA. The Site Manager, ..., may arrange for cleanup ....
4. The owner is responsible for repair, replacement, or removal of the trash container as appropriate within 30 days. If not repaired, replaced, or removed, the Site Manager may arrange for the repair or removal of the container at the owner's expense.

Septic System Maintenance Policy

In December, the Board approved Resolution 2020-06 Septic System Maintenance Policy. **Owners are encouraged to review the entire text of the Policy**, available at www.coolfontmountainside.org in the Owners/Documents section.

Board Shorts

November 7 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes from October 10, 2020 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved payment for legal services, paid from 605 Association Business, Water/Sewer
- Waived Annual Assessment for 2021 for A-6 for Service to the Community
- Approved Snow Plow Contract with Double T through March 2021
- Directed Site Manager to grade and gravel end of Bluebird Lane and install cable across road - to create emergency access road

December 12 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes from November 7, 2020 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved installation of three new Firewise signs throughout community
- Approved Septic System Maintenance Policy Resolution
- Approved renewal of WVOHOA annual membership
- Noted completion of the Reserve Study
- Approved CMA absorb online payment fees as cost of doing business
- Approved Site Manager contract for 2021

January 9 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Elected officers for 2021 year
- Approved 2021 meeting calendar
- Approved minutes from December 12, 2020 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved waiver of late fees on December 2020 water/sewer bills
- Approved WV PSC Proposed Tariffs for Water & Sewer

Front and Back cover photos: Craig Deane (T-2)

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2021 MEMBER

Water & Sewer Tariff Review

The WV PSC completed its review of CMA's financial information and issued a Staff Recommendation Memo in mid-December.

CMA filed a request for additional discussions with PSC staff which were completed in mid-January. The WV PSC issued an order for publication of the recommended tariffs, which CMA must complete by March 15, 2021.

Please watch the Google Group and your email over the next several weeks for details about the PSC Staff Recommendation for the water and sewer tariffs. Once finalized, the Board will schedule a Zoom meeting to engage in community conversation regarding the tariffs and discuss the impact on the future of the community.

Congrats...

to our 2021 Board officers, appointed at the January Board Meeting

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website
www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

Listserv Email

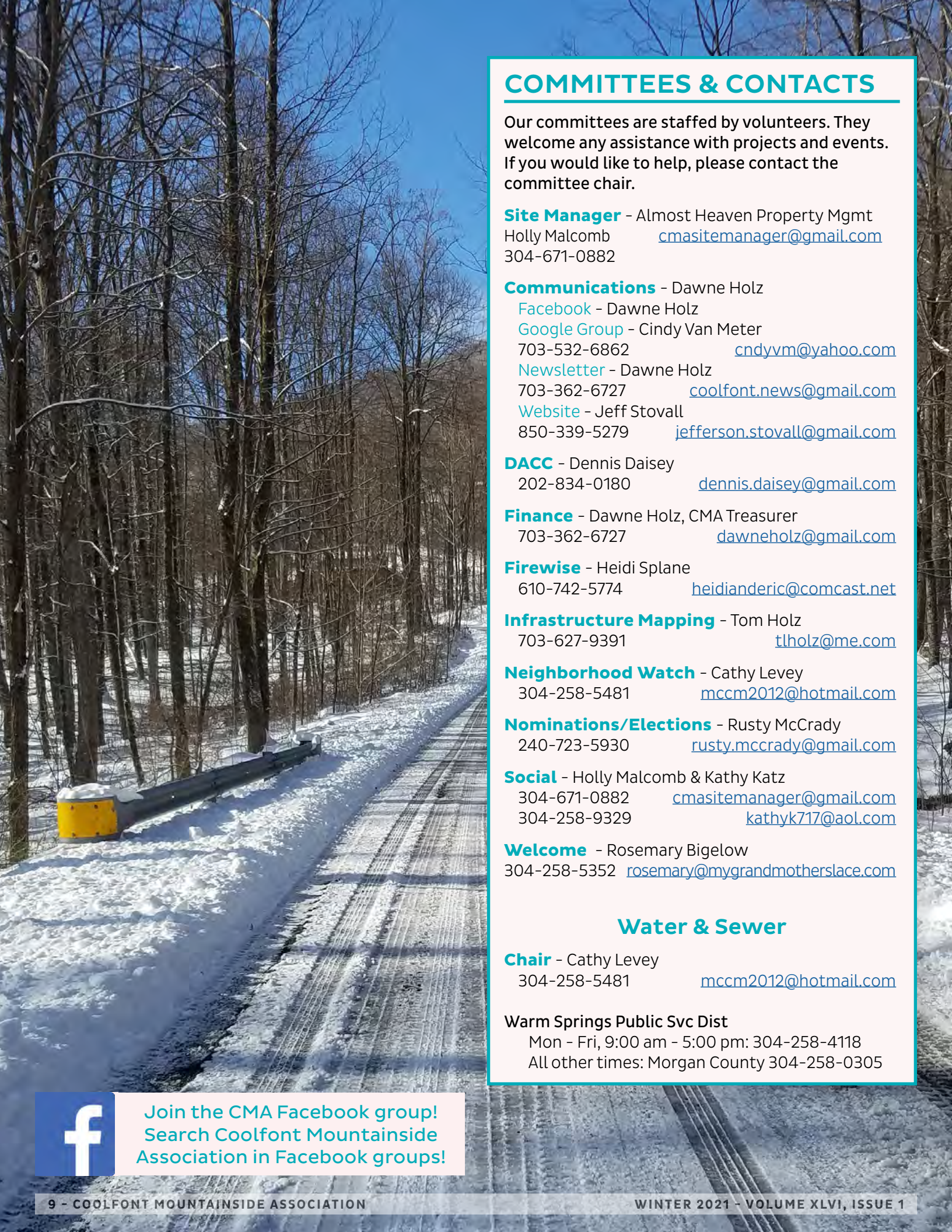
cma-members@googlegroups.com

Listserv Signup/Web

groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Almost Heaven Property Mgmt
Holly Malcomb cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-671-0882

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!